

In Subdomain mode, every subdomain of your master WordPress domain redirects to a different site. It's like your own version of WordPress.com. In Subdirectory mode, as you've no doubt guessed by now, every site resides in its own directory.

Will it work?

If you want to get a Subdirectory-based Network running, all you need is enough configuration to get fancy permalinks working—and this is enabled by default in Ubuntu's Apache.

If you want a Subdomain-based Network running, however, the set-up is a lot more involved, as it requires you to set up a Virtual Host in Apache, and wild-card Domains in your DNS server.

In this article, we'll be setting up a Subdomain-based Network. I assume you have your DNS server up and running somewhere in your organisation, so you'll just need to ask your sys-admin to add a certain DNS record.

Getting started with a Subdomain Network configuration

The first step, of course, is adding a wild-card DNS record to your DNS server, which is shown below:

```
*.example.com. 3600 A 192.0.2.1
```

...or, in shorthand:

```
* 3600 A 192.0.2.1
```

Replace *example.com* and the IP address with your own domain and IP address. Your DNS is now configured.

Next, we'll have to hack the Apache configuration to support wild-cards. Open up your `/etc/httpd.conf` file, and search for the `DocumentRoot` line. Right under that line, add the following code snippet:

```
ServerAlias *.example.com
```

Again, replace *example.com* with your domain. Save the file and quit. This concludes the server software part of the set-up. Now, we'll move on to configuring WordPress itself.

Enabling Network in WordPress

Start by editing the `wp-config.php` file in the root of your website. Just above the line that says `/* That's all, stop editing! Happy blogging. */`, add the following code:

```
define('WP_ALLOW_MULTISITE', true);
```

Now log in to WordPress Administration. In the *Administration* sidebar, under *Tools*, you'll see a new item called *Network*. Click on it.

In this screen, all the data will be filled in automatically, but just in case you want to change anything (you'll only be allowed to change your e-mail address and the name of the Network), go ahead and do so, and then hit *Install*.

Let it run through everything, while it checks and enables Network functionality. Finally, you'll be shown a screen that'll ask you to do a couple of things, roughly in the following order:

1. Create a `blogs.dir` directory under the `wp-content` directory of your website.
2. Add a couple of lines to your `wp-config.php` file (The lines will be given; you'll just have to copy and paste them.)
3. Add some `mod_rewrite` rules to your `htaccess` file, overwriting any existing configuration (again, the generated lines will be given; you'll just have to copy and paste).
4. Click the *Log In* link at the bottom of the page to log in again, thus rendering the *Network* functional.

Now, what if you wanted to set up a Subdirectory based network? When you entered the Network screen in WordPress Administration, you must have noticed that you were given a choice between *Subdomain* and *Subdirectory* (unless some sort of configuration error was preventing you, in which case, the cause was stated on the page). You can select the type from that screen itself. In addition, if you want a Subdirectory based Network, you won't have to tinker with the DNS records and the *ServerAlias* line in Apache.

Where to go next

Now that you have the set-up running, where do you go from here? For starters, have a look at http://codex.wordpress.org/Create_A_Network for information that'll help you run and modify your Network.

The next step would be to create a few sub-blogs. If you already have blogs that you'd like to import into your new Network, visit http://codex.wordpress.org/Migrating_Multiple_Blogs_into_WordPress_3.0_Multisite to learn how to do that.

Well, that's about it. Enjoy your new website :-)



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